

Grammar

Past Perfect Progressive: an action in progress before another past action

We use the Past Perfect Progressive (had been + verb-ing) for an action that was in progress for some time before another action or moment in the past. It highlights the duration and continuity of the earlier action.

Past Perfect Progressive (had been + fiil-ing), geçmişte başka bir geçmiş olaydan önce belirli bir süre devam eden bir eylemi anlatır. Eylemin süresini ve devamlılığını vurgular.

When? We use it to say how long an environmental problem, or a conservation effort, had been going on before another past event.

Bir çevresel sorunun ya da bir koruma çalışmasının, başka bir geçmiş olaydan önce ne kadar süredir devam ettiğini anlatırken kullanılır.

Positive

- Factories had been polluting the river for years.
- We had been recycling for six months before the school project started.

Negative

- The river hadn't been carrying clean water for months.
- They hadn't been protecting the habitat before the new law.

Question

- How long had the volunteers been planting trees?
- Had the animals been migrating there for a long time?

Short answers

- Yes, they had. / No, they hadn't.
- Yes, it had. / No, it hadn't.

Common mistakes

- ~~Factories had polluting the river for years.~~ → **Factories had been polluting the river for years.**
- ~~How long had been the volunteers planting trees?~~ → **How long had the volunteers been planting trees?**

1. Before the new law, factories _____ the river for years.

- a. had been polluting
- b. have polluted
- c. were polluting

2. Scientists _____ the reef for a decade when they found the damage.

- a. study
- b. had been studying
- c. have studied

3. _____ long had the volunteers been planting trees?
- a. How
 - b. What
 - c. Since
4. The elephants _____ (migrate) to that area every winter until their habitat disappeared.
5. The river _____ (not / carry) clean water for months before people noticed.
6. _____ (hunters / kill) too many animals before the ban started?
7. Scientists had studying the reef for a decade. — *True / False*
8. The volunteers had been planting trees for two years before the forest recovered. — *True / False*
9. A: How long _____ the company _____ (pollute) the river before the fine?
10. B: It _____ (pollute) it for almost ten years — nobody had stopped them.
11. Make a question about a conservation project.

Third Conditional: unreal past situations and their results

We use the Third Conditional (If + Past Perfect, ... would have + past participle) to talk about an unreal, imagined situation in the past and its imagined result — the opposite of what really happened.

Third Conditional, geçmişte gerçekleşmemiş, hayalî bir durumu ve onun (yine geçmişte kalan) hayalî sonucunu anlatır: If + Past Perfect, ... would have + V3.

When? We use it to discuss the consequences of environmental action that was, or wasn't, taken in the past.

Geçmişte alınmayan bir çevresel önlemin sonuçlarını, ya da alınan bir önlemin neyi engellediğini tartışırken kullanılır.

Positive

- If we had protected the river earlier, the fish population would have survived.
- The forest would have recovered if people had stopped cutting trees.

Negative

- If people hadn't cut down so many trees, the animals wouldn't have lost their habitat.
- The species wouldn't have become extinct if hunters hadn't hunted it.

Question

- What would have happened if we hadn't protected the reserve?
- Would the river have stayed clean if the factory hadn't polluted it?

Short answers

- Yes, it would. / No, it wouldn't have.
- Yes, they would have. / No, they wouldn't.

Common mistakes

- ~~If people didn't cut down so many trees, the animals wouldn't have lost their habitat.~~ → **If people hadn't cut down so many trees, the animals wouldn't have lost their habitat.**
- ~~The tigers would survive if hunters hadn't killed so many of them.~~ → **The tigers would have survived if hunters hadn't killed so many of them.**

1. If people _____ so many trees, the animals wouldn't have lost their habitat.

- a. didn't cut down
- b. hadn't cut down
- c. don't cut down

2. The tigers _____ if hunters hadn't killed so many of them.

- a. would survive
- b. would have survived
- c. survived

3. If we had protected the river earlier, the fish population _____.

- a. wouldn't disappear
- b. wouldn't have disappeared
- c. didn't disappear

4. If scientists _____ (not warn) us, more species would have become extinct.

5. The water _____ (stay) clean if the factory hadn't released chemicals into the lake.

6. If the government _____ (ban) plastic bags earlier, there would have been less pollution.

7. If we hadn't protected the reserve, more animals would disappear. — *True / False*

8. If hunters hadn't killed so many tigers, the tigers would have survived. — *True / False*

9. A: What _____ (happen) if nobody had protected this forest?

10. B: If nobody _____ (protect) it, it _____ (disappear) years ago.

11. People cut down the forest. The animals lost their habitat. (*Join the ideas with a Third Conditional sentence.*)